

Typography Fundamentals and Font Technology Exploration

1. Typography Terminology Sheet

As someone who just started learning graphic design, these are the main terms I understood:

- **Typeface** – The overall design of letters (example: Arial, Times New Roman)
- **Font** – A specific style of a typeface (like bold, italic, size)
- **Serif** – Fonts with small strokes at the ends (example: Times New Roman)
- **Sans-serif** – Fonts without those strokes, more clean and modern (example: Arial)
- **Kerning** – Space between two letters
- **Leading** – Space between lines of text
- **Tracking** – Overall spacing between letters in a word
- **Baseline** – The line where text sits
- **Ascender/Descender** – Parts of letters that go above or below the normal height
- **Hierarchy** – Organizing text to show importance (headings, subheadings, body text)

2. Font Format Comparison Table

Feature	OTF(open type font)	Open type-SVG
1. Full Form	OpenType Font	OpenType with SVG
2. Colour Support	Mostly single colour	Supports multiple colours
3. Usage	Logos, websites, print	Emojis, creative digital design
4. File Size	Smaller	Larger due to colour data
5. Compatibility	Widely supported	Limited but growing support
6. Features	Ligatures, alternates	Advanced visuals, gradients, textures

3. Short Explanation

As a beginner in graphic design, learning typography has helped me understand that text is not just about writing words—it is also about how those words look and feel. Typography plays a very important role in design because it affects readability, mood, and overall visual appeal.

First, I learned about basic typography terms like typeface, font, kerning, and leading. These terms helped me understand how text is structured. For example, spacing between letters (kerning) and lines (leading) can make a big difference in how easy it is to read something. Before learning this, I never paid attention to spacing, but now I realize it is very important.

I also explored different font formats, especially OTF (OpenType Font). OTF is widely used and supports advanced features like ligatures and alternate characters. It is very useful for both print and digital design because it is flexible and works on most platforms. As a beginner, I find OTF fonts easy to use and reliable.

Another interesting concept I learned is OpenType-SVG fonts. These are different from normal fonts because they can include multiple colours, gradients, and even textures inside the letters. This makes them more creative and visually attractive. They are often used in emojis, illustrations, and modern digital designs. However, they are not supported everywhere yet, so designers need to be careful while using them.

The idea of colour fonts is something new to me. Earlier, I thought fonts were always single-color, but now I understand that fonts can also be colourful and expressive. This opens up more creative possibilities, especially for digital platforms like apps, websites, and social media.